

Killer teeth

Otodus was so large that it could easily prey on smaller whales. Whale bone fossils have been found bearing this giant's bite marks, including a vertebra (backbone) pierced by one of the predator's teeth.

RENEWABLE CHOMPERS

Otodus's teeth were around three times the size of the teeth of modern great white sharks, reaching up to 7 in (18 cm) in length. These robust teeth were continuously shed and replaced by new teeth throughout *Otodus*'s life. This renewal has made fossils of its teeth relatively common.



Great white shark tooth



Otodus tooth

As in other sharks, *Otodus*'s jaws projected outward to seize prey.